



ENG502

Mid-Term

ABSTRACT

This comprehensive collection of notes is accurately crafted to empower students to excel academically, ensuring they achieve a minimum of 80% marks in their examinations. The content is organized with clarity and precision, focusing on key concepts, critical analyses, and practical applications tailored to the syllabus. These notes serve as a reliable resource for both thorough preparation and last-minute revision. Designed to inspire confidence and mastery, this guide is an essential tool for students striving for academic excellence.

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Short Questions (3 Marks Each) Answers

1. Difference between Hyponym and Co-hyponym:

- A *hyponym* is a word that represents a category member (e.g., "rose" is a hyponym of "flower").
- *Co-hyponyms* are words that share the same superordinate (e.g., "rose" and "tulip" are co-hyponyms of "flower").

2. Explain Prototype:

- A prototype is the most typical example of a category (e.g., a robin is a prototype of the category "bird").

3. Forensic Linguistics:

- It is the application of linguistic knowledge to legal contexts, such as analyzing written or spoken language for criminal investigations.

4. What is Particle Movement?:

- A syntactic phenomenon where a particle (like "up" or "off") can shift position in a phrasal verb, e.g., "pick up the book" or "pick the book up."

5. Explain Time Deixis with Two Examples:

- Time deixis refers to expressions that locate events in time, like "now," "then," "tomorrow." E.g., "He came yesterday." / "I will go tomorrow."

6. Right Ear Advantage:

- It is a phenomenon in dichotic listening tasks where the right ear often perceives verbal stimuli more accurately due to left hemisphere language dominance.

7. Difference between Accent and Dialect:

- *Accent* refers to pronunciation differences. *Dialect* includes grammar, vocabulary, and pronunciation specific to a region or group.

8. What is the Wave Model? (Short):

- A theory of language change suggesting that linguistic innovations spread out in waves from a central point, influencing nearby dialects.

9. Define Two-Word Stage:

- A stage in child language acquisition (around 18–24 months) where children begin combining two words, e.g., "mommy go," "want juice."

10. Define Discourse Analysis:

- The study of language use beyond the sentence level, focusing on how texts and conversations are structured.

11. Transformational Rule and Deletion:

- Transformational rules change the structure of sentences, such as converting a statement into a question. Deletion removes elements, like subject deletion in commands (e.g., "Go!").

12. Explain Social/Cultural Context:

- It refers to the background of speakers, including norms, beliefs, and values, which influence language use and interpretation.

13. Name Parts of the Human Brain Related to Language Function:

- Broca's Area, Wernicke's Area, Motor Cortex, Arcuate Fasciculus.

14. Define Neurolinguistics:

- The study of how language is represented in the brain and how brain damage affects language use.

15. Give Synonyms:

- Buy: Purchase
- Big: Large

16. Difference between Diglossia and Polyglossia:

- Diglossia: Two language varieties used in different contexts.
- Polyglossia: The coexistence of more than two varieties/languages in a community.

17. What is IC (Immediate Constituent) Analysis?:

- A method of analyzing sentence structure by breaking it into its immediate parts or constituents.

18. Define Turn-taking:

- A conversational structure where participants alternate speaking roles to maintain dialogue coherence.

19. One Basic Step of Constituent Analysis:

- Dividing a sentence into smaller syntactic units (e.g., noun phrase, verb phrase).

20. Define Affective and Social Meaning:

- Affective meaning expresses speaker's emotions.
- Social meaning conveys social identity or context (e.g., formality).

21. What is the Holophrastic Stage?:

- A stage where a single word represents a whole idea, e.g., "milk" may mean "I want milk."

22. Define Locutionary and Illocutionary Acts:

- *Locutionary*: The actual act of saying something.
- *Illocutionary*: The intended function of the statement (e.g., request, order).

23. Overextension (in Semantics):

- A child's use of a word in a broader context than is appropriate, e.g., calling all animals "dog."

24. Three Features of GTM (Grammar Translation Method):

- Focus on grammar rules, vocabulary memorization, and translation exercises.

25. Three Features of Generative Grammar:

- Rule-governed, recursive, and capable of generating infinite sentences.

26. Age Groups for Babbling, One-Word, Two-Word Stages:

- Babbling: 4–10 months
- One-word: 12–18 months
- Two-word: 18–24 months

27. Basic Divisions of Person Deixis:

- First person (I/we), Second person (you), Third person (he/she/they)

28. Five Ways to Seek Meaning:

- Dictionary, context, word formation, translation, and inference from situation

Long Questions Answers

1. Transformational Rule and Deletion:

- Transformational rules derive complex sentences from simpler ones (deep structure to surface structure). For example, a question like "Are you coming?" transforms from "You are coming."
- Deletion involves omitting redundant elements, such as subject deletion in imperative sentences (e.g., "You go!" becomes "Go!").

2. Particle Movement (Long):

- Particle movement occurs in phrasal verbs where particles can shift position depending on whether the object is a noun or pronoun. E.g., "pick up the book" vs. "pick the book up," but only "pick it up" (not *"pick up it"). The movement obeys syntactic constraints.

3. Wave Model:

- Introduced by Johannes Schmidt, it proposes that linguistic innovations spread like ripples in water. Instead of a linear tree, language change is seen as overlapping circles influencing neighboring dialects and creating linguistic zones. This model better reflects language contact and diffusion.

4. Two-Word Stage:

- Around 18–24 months, children begin forming two-word combinations. These include combinations like "want juice" or "daddy go." It reflects understanding of basic syntactic relations (agent-action, action-object).
- 5. **Discourse Analysis:**
 - It studies language in use across texts and conversations. It involves analyzing cohesion, coherence, turn-taking, and context. Focus is on how meaning is constructed beyond isolated sentences.
- 6. **Term Analysis in Conversation Analysis:**
 - It focuses on how participants manage and organize conversation. Key aspects include turn-taking, adjacency pairs, repair mechanisms, and sequence organization to analyze interaction structure.
- 7. **What Researchers Describe in SLA (Second Language Acquisition):**
 - Researchers examine stages of learning, factors affecting acquisition (motivation, age, exposure), interlanguage, error analysis, and the effectiveness of teaching methods.
- 8. **Critical Discourse Analysis (CDA):**
 - CDA studies how power, dominance, and inequality are enacted through language. It involves analyzing texts to reveal hidden ideologies and social structures. Common in media, political, and institutional discourse analysis.
- 9. **Social/Cultural Context in Language:**
 - Language use is shaped by societal norms, values, and cultural expectations. Social context influences politeness, formality, and interpretation. Cultural background affects pragmatics, speech acts, and communicative competence.

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